Team Expectations Agreement[1]

When working in a team, problems occasionally arise. One source of problems is the differing expectations of team members. For example, one person may think that an email response should come within 2 hours, while another may think that 2 days is acceptable.

This document will serve as a guideline while working on establishing team expectations. In the space below, write down the list of agreed upon guidelines that your team intends to follow. Include guidelines for the following:

• Methods of communication (email, phone, messenger, text, . . .) •

Communication response times (email, phone, messenger, text, . . .) • Meeting

attendance (when to meet, whether all meetings are mandatory, . . .) • Running

meetings (when, where, face-to-face vs. online, who takes minutes, . . .) • Meeting

preparation (whether preparation is needed, what to prepare, . . .) • Version

control (what to/not to commit, content of log messages, . . .) • Division of work

(how to divide work, who will decide who does what, . . .)

- Submitting assignments (when to submit, who will submit, who will review the sub mission, . . .)
- Contingency planning (what if a team member drops out, what if a team member consistently misses meetings, what if a team member is academically dishonest, . . .) We suggest that in these cases, a team promptly seeks help from the instructor. It is important not to let such situations escalate.

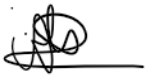
The list above is just meant to get you started. If you had any team problems in the past, think about what went wrong and how expectations can be set to prevent those types of problems.

(Continued on the other side.)

[1]Based on *Turning Groups into Effective Teams*, Barbara Oakley et al., 2004.

Team Guidelines (continued)

We accept these guidelines (written in the page 3 of this document) and intend to fulfill them (sign below):

Name (print)	Signature	Date
Alp Duras		2025/09/16
Sahil Panchal	SP	2025/09/16
Zack Nayar	ZN	2025/09/16
Arsh Dhothar	AD	2025/09/16
Ibrahim Khalil	IK	

At the time when you will submit the sprint 0 materials, please submit this document as well. In the event of team disagreements, you may be asked to show this form to your instructor.

Team Guidelines (continued)

Please write down your guidelines on this page.

Communication:

- Group chat (Discord or Instagram): Respond within 12 hours
- Emails: Within 24 hours
- Phone/text (For urgent matters): Respond as soon as possible

Meetings:

- Whenever necessary, all group members must attend or if they are busy for that set date ask to reschedule to a date they and everyone else can accommodate within a timely manner
- Online by default, can be moved in person
- Notes should be taken during meetings

Preparation

- Finish tasks before meetings
- Bring questions to meetings if necessary

Version Control:

- Avoid overwriting another group member's work without first asking
- Communicate changed with each other especially major changes
- Work should be clearly labelled to avoid confusion or misunderstanding

Division of Work:

- Split work based of strengths and skills, once split you are solely responsible to complete it, ask for help from the rest of the group if need be
- Everyone is accountable for their work
- If struggling reach out to other members of the group to meet the expectations set

Submitting Assignments:

- Attempt to get everything done the day before the deadline leaving a day for review. (This doesn't mean everything should be left to be done the day before the deadline)
- All members should review the work before submission
- One designated member will submit the finalized version upon approval from the rest of the group

Contingency Plan:

- Member drops out: Redistribute their work equally
- Repeated Absences: Discuss internally and reach out to the instructor if unresolved
- Academic Dishonesty: Not allowed by any group members and you will be asked to change your work if noticed.

General Plan:

- Respect each other for a safe working environment
- Communicate with each other clearly to avoid misunderstandings especially when deadlines are approaching
- Members shouldn't feel like they are doing excessively more work than other group members
- Help each other out as needed. Just because you weren't assigned a part it doesn't mean you shouldn't help a member out.